

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 2
♥ A 7 6 4
♦ J T 7 3
♣ T 5

♠ A K 9 8 6 5

♥ 9

♦ A Q 6

♣ A K 2



♠ T 3
♥ Q J T 8
♦ K 8 2
♣ 9 7 6 4

♠ 7 4

♥ K 5 3 2

♦ 9 5 4

♣ Q J 8 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♥Q.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♥Q.

Losers: ♠ 1? : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4?

That question mark means that if ♠s don't split 3-2 you will have 2 losers in which case the ♦ finesse will just have to work. However, the 3-2 split will probably occur, so you make your PLAN based on that.

Unless East is a complete moron dummy's ♥K is a goner no matter what you do. So you duck, then ruff the ♥J continuation. Next you play ♠A, ♠K, both defenders following. At this point one defender still holds the master ♠Q and you must decide whether to leave it outstanding or force them to play it.

When dummy has a side suit you want to run but no outside entries it usually pays to drive out the master trump. So you play another ♠ and West wins the ♠Q. He now plays a ♦ and you hopefully play the ♦Q, but East takes the ♦K and plays another ♦. You are now in control. Win the ♦A and play 4 rounds of ♣s, discarding your ♦ loser.

Imagine you had NOT driven out the ♠Q.

You would have played ♣A, ♣K, then a small ♣ to dummy's ♣J. West would ruff this with his ♠Q and you would never be able to reach dummy's ♣J. You would be down 1, losing 1 ♠, 1 ♥ and 2 ♦s.

With 22 points you are too strong to open with a 1-bid.

You start with a forcing 2♣, partner responds 2♦. This is a "waiting" bid, showing 0-7 points.

No need to jump. If you say anything other than 2NT partner is forced to bid again.

You bid 2♠ and it is partner who says 2NT.

Always keep in mind that you don't need to bid the same values twice. Partner knows that you have 22 or more points and knows that you have a good ♠ suit. So all you do at this point is rebid your ♠s to show that it is a 6-card suit.

You bid 3♠ and partner raises you to game.

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q
♥ T 8 5
♦ K Q J T
♣ 7 6 3 2

♠ 9 8 7 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ A 8 5

♣ A K Q



♠ K J 2

♥ Q J 7 2

♦ 7 3

♣ T 9 5 4

♠ T 6 5 4

♥ A K 3

♦ 9 6 4 2

♣ J 8

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

All Pass

2 ♠ by South

3 as long as the defenders don't get a ruff. But if the defender with a doubleton trump happened to get a ruff then your trump losers would go to 4. You should lead trumps to try to prevent this.

So win the ♦ A and lead a ♠. West will win and play 3 high ♦s. You ruff the third one in dummy. East may over-ruff, and if he does you can hope that he was the defender who started with 3 trumps. Suppose East now leads a ♥. You win in your hand and play another trump, happily observing the ♠ K and ♠ A both fall. You win the rest of the tricks, discarding your ♥ loser on dummy's third ♣.

When the defenders have a lot of high trumps you have to try to make sure they fall on the same tricks.

You were a little lucky that the defender who got the ruff, East, was the one who started with 3 trumps.

There are three legitimate choices, 1 ♦, 1 ♠ or 1NT.

You should always show a Major suit if you can, even a poor one like this.

You bid 1 ♠. Partner says 2 ♠ and

Partner has a minimum opener. You pass in a flash.

South plays 2 ♠. West leads the ♦ K.

South plays 2 ♠. West leads the ♦ K.

Losers: ♠ 3? : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 6?

Your ♥ loser can disappear on dummy's third ♣.

If ♠s split 3-2 you can hold your losers in the suit to 3 as long as the defenders don't get a ruff. But if the defender with a doubleton trump happened to get a ruff then your trump losers would go to 4. You should lead trumps to try to prevent this.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 5 4 2
♥ A 9 6 3
♦ J 8 3
♣ K 4

♠ A K 3

♥ K 4

♦ A K 6 5

♣ J 8 7 2



♠ J 8 6

♥ Q J 8 7 2

♦ T 9 4

♣ 6 3

♠ Q T 7

♥ T 5

♦ Q 7 2

♣ A Q T 9 5

West

North

East

South

1♦

Pass

2♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

you know that if you lose the lead there will be a deluge of ♥s on the table. ♣s is your best suit, and if the finesse works you will make 6. Of course if it fails you will go down. But there is one thing you should do before you stake everything on a 50% finesse. You should play 3 rounds of ♦s. If they split 3-3 you will have found your ninth trick and you won't risk the ♣ finesse.

If you try the ♣ finesse you will go down, losing 1 ♣ and 4 ♥s. If you take your 4 ♦ tricks and refuse to try the ♣ finesse you will make the contract.

The best thing about this plan is that when you test the ♦s, if it turns out they do not split 3-3 you can still try the ♣ finesse.

You are too strong to open 1NT. With two 4-card minors the correct opening bid is 1♦. Partner responds 2♣.

You now need to make a jump bid. You **MIGHT** jump to 4♣ but that would bypass what is probably your best game. Instead you just jump to 3NT. Partner doesn't **HAVE** to pass, but he does.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥7 West wins ♥A and returns ♥9.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥7 West wins ♥A and returns ♥9.

Winner count: ♠ 3 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 8

You have a **LOT** of points - but only 8 tricks. And

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
 ♥ K Q T 7
 ♦ J T 8 2
 ♣ 9

♠ A 8 5 3

♥ A 6 4 2

♦ K 7

♣ A K 5



♠ K

♥ J 9 8 3

♦ Q 9 5 4 3

♣ 6 4 2

♠ T 7 6 2

♥ 5

♦ A 6

♣ Q J T 8 7 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

pull trumps. You win the ♥ A and play the ♠ A. East plays the ♠ K!

Do you change your Plan? Click?

Do you change your **PLAN**?

Well, East may be false-carding. He may also have the ♠ Q for example. But if you decide to play another trump and it turns out he was NOT false-carding you will be dead in the water. West will take his three trump tricks and some ♥s. Many ♥s.

So don't take the chance. Abandon trumps and start playing ♣ winners. Let West take the three trumps whenever he wants to. You will not lose control of the hand and will make your 10 tricks.

The risk of leading a second trump was too great.

As you see, West would have pulled your and dummy's trumps and then won 3 ♥ tricks.

A slightly different Plan would also have worked. At trick two you could have played a low trump from both hands. East would win the ♠ K, then probably play another ♥. You ruff, play a ♠ to the ♠ A and discover the split. From there the Plan is the same, play your ♣s and let West ruff when he wants.

Well, you're pretty sure you have a ♣ fit. But before you show partner your fine ♣ support you have an obligation to show a 4-card Major.

You respond 1 ♠, partner jumps to 3 ♠.

Your hand revalues to 11 or 12 points so you should bid game. 5 ♣ requires 11 tricks and 4 ♠ only 10 tricks. You bid 4 ♠.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♥ K.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♥ K.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 0 : Total = 2

You expect trumps to split 3-2 so you would lose 2 trumps. You have no other losers so you decide to

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 5
 ♥ K 9 8 3
 ♦ Q J 9 5 3
 ♣ 6

♠ A K 8 7 4 2

♥ A 6

♦ A T 2

♣ 5 3



♠ J T

♥ Q J T 2

♦ K 8

♣ T 9 8 4 2

♠ 6 3

♥ 7 5 4

♦ 7 6 4

♣ A K Q J 7

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by North

the rest of the tricks are yours because you can run the ♣ suit without anyone trumping in.

Of course you open 1 ♠. Partner responds 2 ♣.

With 17 points and a 6-card suit you jump to 3 ♠. Partner bids the game.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♥ Q.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♥ Q.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

You have plenty of ♣ winners in dummy but you must be careful because there are no outside entries. You win your ♥ A and play ♠ A and ♠ K, both defenders following suit. The ♠ Q is still out. To make sure you get to enjoy those ♣ winners you should continue with another ♠, forcing out the ♠ Q.

The defense will now take a ♥ if they are smart, but

Think through what would have happened if you had not forced out the ♠ Q.

West would have used his master ♠ Q to ruff the second ♣, before you had taken any discards. You would still have to lose a ♥ and two ♦ s.